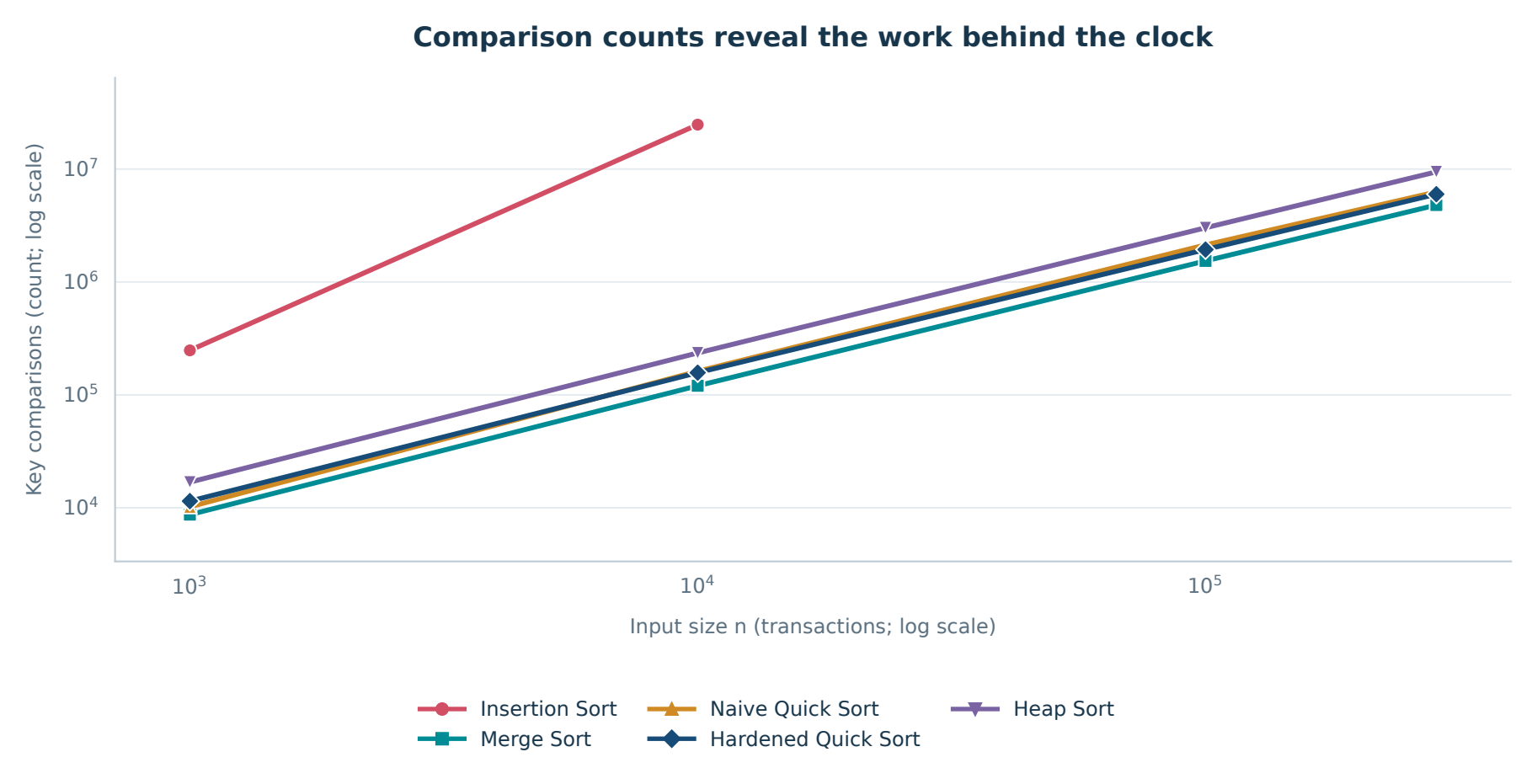
Comparison counts reveal the work behind the clock
Key comparisons (count; log scale)
10^7
10^6
10^5
10^4
10^3
10^4
10^5
Input size n (transactions; log scale)
Insertion Sort
Naive Quick Sort
Heap Sort
Merge Sort
Hardened Quick Sort